

BONUS 2 OF 5 · FREE WITH YOUR COLLECTION

Illustrated Stitch Dictionary

Every stitch used in the patterns, from the chain to textured relief stitches — with the US abbreviation, its UK name, the chart symbol and each movement step by step.

26 stitches & techniques

US ↔ UK terms

Chart symbols

Swatch photos



The Crochet Backpack Collection

US terms · cm & inches · 2026 edition

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How to read a pattern

All the patterns in the collection use **US terms**. If you learned with UK patterns, the names shift by one: a UK "double" is a US "single". This table is the translation.

US ABBREVIATION	US NAME	UK NAME
ch	chain	chain
sl st	slip stitch	slip stitch (ss)
sc	single crochet	double crochet (dc)
hdc	half double crochet	half treble (htr)
dc	double crochet	treble (tr)
tr	treble crochet	double treble (dtr)
sc2tog / dec	single crochet 2 together	dc2tog
FPdc / BPdc	front / back post double crochet	FPtr / BPtr
rev sc	reverse single crochet (crab)	crab stitch

Pattern notation

- ***...* x5** — repeat the instructions between asterisks 5 times.
- **(sc 2, inc) x6** — repeat the group in parentheses 6 times.
- **(24)** at the end — stitch count after that row/round.
- **Rnd** = round (worked in a circle) · **Row** = worked back and forth, turning.
- **sk** skip · **sp** space · **st(s)** stitch(es) · **yo** yarn over · **tch** turning chain · **RS/WS** right/wrong side · **FO** fasten off · **MR** magic ring.

Turning chains in this collection

STITCH	TURNING CH	COUNTS AS A STITCH?
sc	ch 1	No
hdc	ch 2	No
dc	ch 3 / ch 2	ch 3 yes · ch 2 no
tr	ch 4	Yes

Chart symbol key

 ch 5 chain	 sl st in each ch sl st	 sc	 hdc	 dc	 tr
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PART 1

Foundation stitches

The six stitches every pattern in the collection is built on.



ch 5

Chain

US: ch

UK: ch (same)

Used for: Every foundation, turning chains, straps, button loops.

1. Make a slip knot and put it on the hook; hold the tail with your middle finger and thumb.
2. Yarn over (yo): wrap the working yarn over the hook from back to front.
3. Pull the yarn through the loop on the hook. That is 1 chain.
4. Repeat. Count chains by the V's on the front — never count the loop on the hook or the slip knot.

Tip • Tight foundation chains are the #1 reason bag bottoms pucker. Chain with a hook one size larger, then switch.



sl st in each ch

Slip Stitch

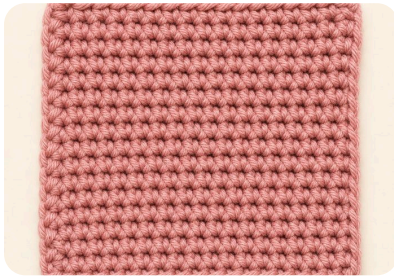
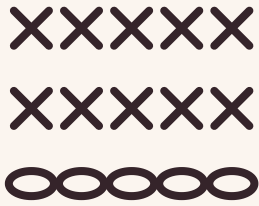
US: sl st

UK: ss

Used for: Joining rounds, sl st edges under zippers, moving yarn without adding height.

1. Insert the hook into the stitch.
2. Yarn over.
3. Pull through the stitch AND the loop on the hook in one movement.

Tip • For a sl st edge under a zipper, keep the stitches loose — pull each one to the height of the stitch below.



Single Crochet

US: sc

UK: dc (double crochet)

Used for: The main stitch of most backpack bodies and all bottoms; dense, firm, holds shape.

1. Insert the hook into the stitch (under both top loops).
2. Yarn over and pull up a loop (2 loops on hook).
3. Yarn over and pull through both loops. 1 sc made.
4. At the end of a row: ch 1 (does not count as a stitch), turn, first sc goes into the first stitch.

Tip · UK patterns call this a 'double crochet'. Every pattern in this collection uses US terms.

hdc = T



Half Double Crochet

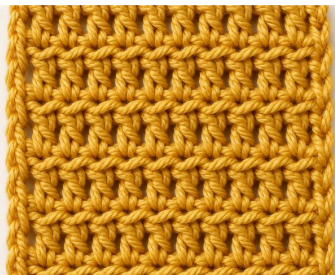
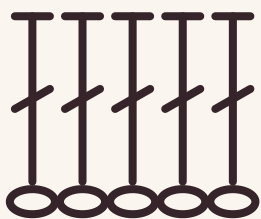
US: hdc

UK: htr (half treble)

Used for: Faster bodies with more drape; straps; the kiss-lock purse.

1. Yarn over first (2 loops on hook... counting the wrap).
2. Insert the hook into the stitch, yarn over and pull up a loop (3 loops on hook).
3. Yarn over and pull through all 3 loops at once. 1 hdc made.
4. Turning chain: ch 2. In this collection the ch 2 does NOT count as a stitch unless the pattern says so.

Tip · Behind every hdc row there is a third horizontal loop. Working into it (the 'camel stitch') makes a knit-look rib.



Double Crochet

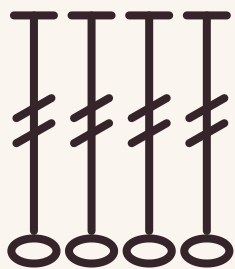
US: dc

UK: tr (treble)

Used for: Shells, V-stitch, half circles, post-stitch textures, fast panels.

1. Yarn over, insert the hook into the stitch.
2. Yarn over and pull up a loop (3 loops on hook).
3. Yarn over, pull through 2 loops (2 on hook).
4. Yarn over, pull through the last 2 loops. 1 dc made. Turning chain: ch 3 (usually counts as a dc) or ch 2 (does not count).

Tip · Always check what the pattern says about the turning chain — it is where edges get wavy or grow a stitch per row.



Treble Crochet

US: tr

UK: dtr (double treble)

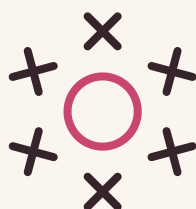
Used for: Tall decorative rows, eyelets for drawstrings, lace edgings.

1. Yarn over TWICE, insert the hook into the stitch.
2. Yarn over and pull up a loop (4 loops on hook).
3. *Yarn over, pull through 2 loops* three times. 1 tr made.
4. Turning chain: ch 4.

Tip · A row of tr with ch-1 between them makes the perfect channel for a backpack drawstring cord.

Shaping & loops

How pieces grow, shrink and get their ridges.



MR, 6 sc

Magic Ring

US: MR

UK: magic loop

Used for: Every flat round bottom and every circle, with no hole in the center.

1. Wrap the yarn twice around two fingers, tail in front.
2. Insert the hook under both strands, pick up the working yarn and pull up a loop. Ch 1 to lock it (does not count).
3. Work the first round (e.g. 6 sc) into the ring, over both strands.
4. Pull the tail firmly: the hole closes. Join with sl st or continue in spiral.

Tip · For t-shirt yarn or macramé cord, make the ring with only ONE wrap — two wraps are too thick to close.



2 sc in 1 st

Increase

US: inc

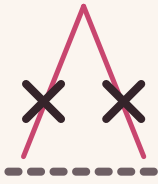
UK: inc / 2dc in next

Used for: Round bottoms (+6 sc per round), widening panels, half circles.

1. Work 1 stitch in the next stitch.
2. Work a second stitch in the SAME stitch. 1 stitch became 2.
3. In rounds, spread increases evenly: (sc 1, inc), (sc 2, inc), (sc 3, inc)...
4. Stagger them every other round (e.g. sc 2, inc, sc 2 instead of sc 4, inc) to keep a round bottom from turning hexagonal.

Tip · If a flat circle cups, you need more increases; if it ruffles, fewer — or a smaller hook.

2 sts become 1



Invisible Decrease

US: dec

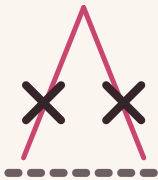
UK: dec

Used for: Closing rounded shapes, shaping flaps, amigurumi-style details on backpacks.

1. Insert the hook into the FRONT loop only of the next stitch.
2. Without yarning over, insert it into the front loop only of the following stitch (3 loops on hook).
3. Yarn over, pull through the 2 front loops (2 on hook).
4. Yarn over, pull through both. 2 stitches became 1, with no gap.

Tip · When a pattern just says 'dec' in a round, this is the neatest option. For flat rows use sc2tog (next entry).

2 sts become 1



Single Crochet Two Together

US: sc2tog

UK: dc2tog

Used for: Tapered flaps, rounding panel corners, clutch points. hdc2tog works the same with a yarn over first.

1. Insert the hook into the next stitch, yarn over, pull up a loop (2 on hook).
2. Insert into the following stitch, yarn over, pull up a loop (3 on hook).
3. Yarn over and pull through all 3 loops. 1 stitch made from 2.
4. hdc2tog: (yo, insert, yo, pull up a loop) in each of 2 sts, yo, pull through all 5 loops.

Tip · On flaps, decrease at both ends of the same row so the point stays centered.



arc below = front loop

Front Loop Only

US: FLO

UK: FLO

Used for: Decorative ridges, and the base round where you later add a frill or pocket.

1. Look at the top of the stitch: two loops form a V.
2. The front loop is the one closest to you.
3. Insert the hook under the front loop only and work the stitch as usual.
4. The unused back loop stays free as a horizontal line.

Tip · Leaving free loops on one round gives you a ready-made line to attach a pocket later — no sewing.





Back Loop Only

US: BLO

UK: BLO

Used for: The sharp edge between a backpack bottom and its sides; ribbed flaps and straps.

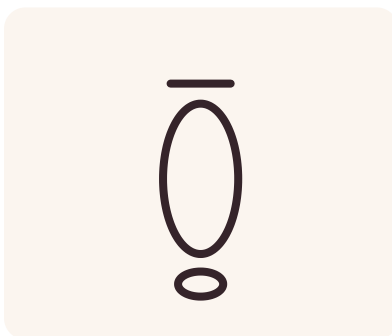
1. Find the back loop: the one farther from you.
2. Insert the hook under the back loop only and work the stitch.
3. The front loop stays as a raised ridge on the right side.
4. One round of sc BLO after the bottom = crisp, flat base.

Tip · Worked in rows, BLO creates ribbing; worked in rounds, a single line. Rows 2–24 of the ribbed envelope wallet use it.

PART 3

Texture & relief

The stitches that make a backpack look designed, not just made.



Puff Stitch

US: puff

UK: puff

Used for: Soft textured bands on backpack fronts, the puff wristlet pouch.

1. *Yarn over, insert into the stitch, yarn over, pull up a loop to hdc height* 4 times (9 loops on hook).
2. Yarn over and pull through all 9 loops.
3. Ch 1 to close the puff (the ch-1 does not count as a stitch).
4. Next round/row: work 1 sc in the top of the puff and 1 in each ch-sp.

Tip · Pull every loop up to the same height before the next one; uneven loops make lumpy puffs.



Bobble

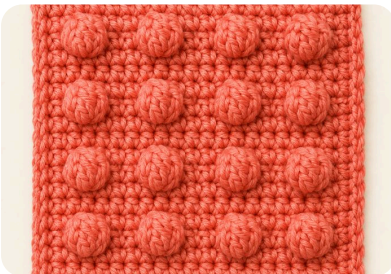
US: bobble (5-dc)

UK: bobble

Used for: Raised dots on bags and clutches; 4-dc bobbles with macramé cord.

1. *Yarn over, insert into the SAME stitch, yarn over, pull up a loop, yarn over, pull through 2 loops* 5 times (6 loops on hook).
2. Yarn over and pull through all 6 loops.
3. The bobble pops out on the side facing AWAY from you.
4. Surround bobbles with sc (flat rows: work bobbles on wrong-side rows).

Tip · In rounds with the right side facing you, push each bobble outward with a finger as you go.



Popcorn

US: pc (5-dc)

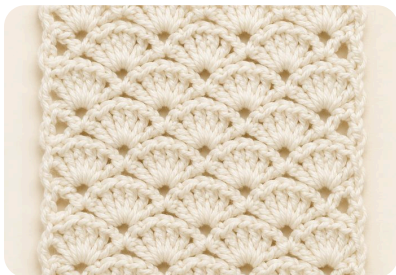
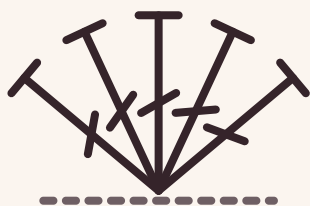
UK: popcorn

Used for: The tallest, most 3D dot; the popcorn snap-frame pouch.

1. Work 5 dc in the same stitch.
2. Take the hook out of the loop, leaving it big.
3. Insert the hook from front to back into the top of the FIRST dc, then pick up the dropped loop.
4. Pull the dropped loop through the first dc. Ch 1 to lock it.

Tip · Popcorns eat about 3x the yarn of a sc; add 20% more yarn to a pattern if you add a popcorn band.

5 dc in same st



Shell Stitch

US: shell

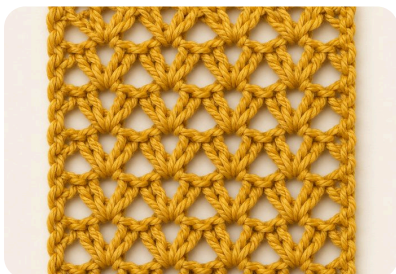
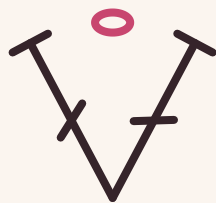
UK: shell

Used for: Scalloped fabric (evening clutch), pretty flap edgings.

1. Skip 2 stitches.
2. Work 5 dc into the next stitch — this fan is the shell.
3. Skip 2 stitches, sc in the next stitch.
4. Next row: sc goes into the center dc of each shell, shells go into the sc's.

Tip • Shell fabric has gaps: line any bag made in shells, or small things fall through.

dc, ch 1, dc



V-Stitch

US: V-st

UK: V-st (tr, ch 1, tr)

Used for: Airy summer clutches and beach backpacks.

1. Work 1 dc in the stitch.
2. Ch 1.
3. Work 1 dc in the SAME stitch. That's 1 V.
4. Next row: every V goes into the ch-1 space of the V below.

Tip • Only the first V row needs counting; afterwards the V's stack on top of each other.



hook curves to the front



Front Post Double Crochet

US: FPdc

UK: FPtr

Used for: Ribbed straps, top cuffs, basketweave.

1. Yarn over.
2. Insert the hook from FRONT to back to front AROUND the post (the vertical body) of the stitch below — not into the top.
3. Yarn over, pull up a loop, then (yarn over, pull through 2) twice.
4. The stitch sits raised toward you.

Tip · Post stitches use about 30% more yarn and pull the fabric narrower. Count them in the pattern, don't add.



hook curves to the back

Back Post Double Crochet

US: BPdc

UK: BPtr

Used for: Paired with FPdc: ribbing (FPdc 1, BPdc 1) and basketweave (4 and 4).

1. Yarn over.
2. Insert the hook from BACK to front to back around the post of the stitch below.
3. Yarn over, pull up a loop, then (yarn over, pull through 2) twice.
4. The stitch recedes away from you.

Tip · On the wrong side, a FPdc looks like a BPdc from the front. That is why basketweave rows can read the same on both sides.



hook between the V legs



Waistcoat Stitch (Knit Stitch)

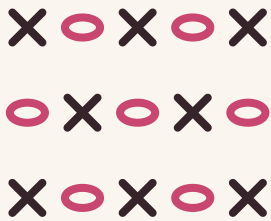
US: waistcoat st / ksc

UK: centre sc

Used for: Knit-look bodies; very dense and firm, great for card wallets and backpack bottoms.

1. Work in the round, right side always facing you.
2. Look at the sc below: it shows a V on the front.
3. Insert the hook BETWEEN the two legs of the V (through the center of the stitch), not under the top loops.
4. Complete a normal sc. Keep loops loose — go up one hook size.

Tip · If the fabric leans, you are not joining at the same place every round. Join and ch 1 at a marker.



sc into the ch-1 space



Moss / Linen Stitch

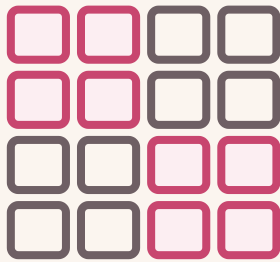
US: moss st

UK: moss / granite st

Used for: Flat, woven-look wallets and clutches that don't curl; stripes look amazing in it.

1. Chain an EVEN number. Sc in the 4th ch from hook, *ch 1, skip 1 ch, sc in next ch* to the end.
2. Next row: ch 2, turn, sc in the first ch-1 space, *ch 1, skip the sc, sc in next ch-1 space* across.
3. The last sc goes into the turning-chain space.
4. Repeat that row. You always work INTO the spaces, never into the sc.

Tip · US 'moss stitch' and 'linen stitch' are the same stitch. Changing color every 2 rows creates a tweed look.



FP blocks / BP blocks



Basketweave

US: FPdc/BPdc blocks

UK: basketweave

Used for: Structured bags, wallets, t-shirt yarn clutches.

1. Row 1: dc across a multiple of 8 stitches.
2. Rows 2–3: *FPdc 4, BPdc 4* across.
3. Rows 4–5: *BPdc 4, FPdc 4* across — the blocks switch.
4. Repeat Rows 2–5. Turning ch 2 does not count; the first post st goes around the first stitch.

Tip · Keep the stitch count a multiple of 8 and the two rows of each band will be written identically.

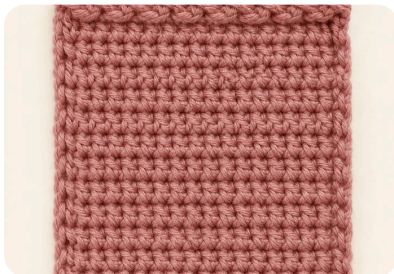
PART 4

Edges, joins & finishing

Where handmade starts to look store-bought.



work left → right



Crab Stitch

US: rev sc

UK: crab st / rev dc

Used for: Rope-like finishing edge on flaps, pockets and bag tops.

1. Do not turn. Work from LEFT to RIGHT (right-handed).
2. Insert the hook into the next stitch to the right, from front to back.
3. Yarn over, pull up a loop, twisting the hook down (2 loops).
4. Yarn over and pull through both loops. Continue to the right.

Tip · If it feels awkward, it's correct. Keep the first loop long so the hook can reach back.



change on last yo

Changing Color

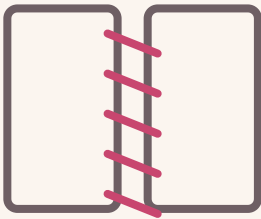
US: —

UK: —

Used for: Stripes, color blocks, contrast edgings, monograms.

1. Work the last stitch in the old color until 2 loops remain on the hook.
2. Drop the old color, yarn over with the NEW color and pull through.
The top of the stitch is already the new color.
3. In rounds: change on the last yarn-over of the joining sl st; start with sl st + ch 1 in the same stitch (jogless).
4. Carry the unused color inside (rounds) or up the side edge (rows) if you'll use it again within 4 rows; otherwise cut it.

Tip · Surface slip stitch: hold the yarn behind the finished fabric and sl st through it to 'draw' letters or lines.



Sewing Pieces Together

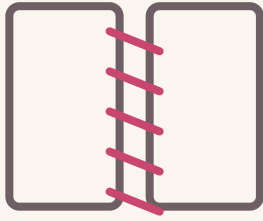
US: —

UK: —

Used for: Joining panels, attaching pockets, closing straps.

1. Whipstitch: pieces wrong sides together, needle through both edge loops always from the same side. Fast, visible diagonal.
2. Mattress stitch: pieces flat, right sides up; go under a horizontal bar on one side, then the other, pull tight every 4 stitches — invisible seam.
3. Sc seam: hook through both layers, sc along the edge. A decorative ridge that also reinforces.
4. Sl st seam: same, with sl st, from the wrong side — flat and invisible outside.

Tip · Use a blunt tapestry needle and the same yarn; for t-shirt yarn, split it lengthwise or use upholstery thread.



Fastening Off & Weaving In

US: FO

UK: FO

Used for: Every piece. It is where finished bags come apart after a month.

1. Cut the yarn leaving 15 cm / 6 in, yarn over, pull the tail all the way through the last loop.
2. Thread the tail on a tapestry needle.
3. Weave 5 cm / 2 in in one direction through the backs of the stitches, then 2 cm back in the opposite direction.
4. Cut close. For cotton and cord, weave through 3 directions — they are slippery.

Tip · Invisible finish on rounds: skip the last sl st, pull the tail through, pass the needle under both loops of the 2nd stitch and back into the last one.

Stuck on a stitch?

Come back to this dictionary any time a pattern uses an abbreviation you don't recognize. Every stitch in the 50 backpacks and the 30 wallets is on these pages.

The Crochet Backpack Collection